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# **Reflective Portfolio Assignment II Instructions**

Introductory Psychology

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## 1 Pre-assignment Reminders

- Prior to attempting this assignment, I strongly recommend that you have completed all other work through module 7, including:
  - Having watched all lectures thoroughly and taken notes (optionally with the guided notes)
  - Reading all assigned sections of the book, and completing practice examples as helpful and useful
  - Completing relevant lecture check-ins
  - Completing all quizzes, and reviewing correct answers at the end of the week
- If you are confused while completing this assignment, consider coming to my office hours or reaching out to me via email.
- All syllabus and university policies on academic integrity, plagiarism, and other forms of misconduct apply to this assignment. Please review them if you are unfamiliar. There is zero-tolerance for failure to adhere to these policies and acting un-ethically will result in automatic failure on the assignment and referral to OSCCR.

### ! Important

Remember, it is most important to me that you can defend the process by which you create your work and demonstrate that it represents your knowledge and abilities. Also recall that it is unacceptable to copy-paste instructions from any assignment in this class into another program or prompt.

## 2 Prompt

This is the second of three reflective portfolio assignments that you will complete throughout the PSY-101 semester. These are designed to help bring this PSY-101 class in line with the 'Embarking Experience' as part of CLAS Voyage at GVSU. Please see the course learning objectives in the course syllabus and [this website for more information](#). Please keep track of what you say and write as part of these reflective portfolio assignments, as I'll ask you to connect your three different portfolio assignments. For this second assignment, I'd like you to respond to this prompt:

In a mini-essay of **at least 600 words**:

Identify **3 psychological concepts/theories/findings/ideas** that you have learned about this semester so far. How can these be applied to benefit your life, either now or in the future? Please identify concepts/theories/findings that apply to different aspects of your life (e.g., academic learning, mental health, physical health, relationships, motivation and emotions, etc.). In particular, I am interested to see learn about how what you learn in

this class might relate to your life a student, like in how you involve yourself with campus events or organizations, academic performance, residence life, etc.

### 3 Checklist

#### ! Important

Your grade on this assignment is based in good-faith completion - you must address each of the components below to get full points. Failure to properly source your information and answers (per the 2nd and 4th checkboxes) will result in an automatic 0 points. For the purpose of this assignment, please do not refer to outside sources not covered in this course.

- ☐ The final essay is at least 600 words
- ☐ Identify 3 psychological concepts/theories/findings/ideas that you think could be helpful to you, from the lecture content
- ☐ For each of the above three things, gave an explicit citation to the lectures with slide and/or page numbers from the lecture presentations and/or notes, respectively
- ☐ For each of the above three things, identify how *specifically* you could apply the knowledge from what you learned to improve your life (or how they have already helped improve your life)?

### 4 Instructor Example

#### ! Important

You should NOT re-use this example/strategy for your own essay

*The below example contains 1 example of a thing that I've learned to help improve my life, a direct citation to the lectures, and how I can apply this. It is roughly 223 words. So, the example below is roughly half of what you must complete for your own submission. Please use this to help guide you on what I am expecting for this assignment.*

"Both when I was younger, and now when I am slightly older, I've had a sort of 'invincibility complex' that often makes it feel as if I am immune to major physical or mental harm, which is fairly common in younger people. One thing that I've been thinking about is that during the biopsychology unit, we talked about the function of each part of the brain

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*"I don't mind not knowing. It doesn't scare me." — Richard P. Feynman*

and how damage to it can cause major change. For example, on page 17 of the module 3 notes, we had discussed Phineas Gage, a railroad worker with injurious frontal lobe damage that changed his personality. Though he lived through the injury, he wasn't the same man afterward. That had me critically thinking about all the dumb and sometimes dangerous things I've done in my life: like playing backyard football and soccer with my friend in high school, or driving when too tired, or even just walking too fast when it is icy outside. I think learning about this made me realize that I need to be really conscious of my safety, specifically the safety of my brain. Ever since learning that, I've tried to be moving (metaphorically and literally) a lot slower and more carefully, thinking about how to keep my brain and body safe so that I can avoid something that may irrevocably change me. I know next time I ride a bike, I'll for sure be wearing my helmet!"